

Advice for Group Presentation

The Craft of Computing

Aug 10, 2026

Outline

- Overview of the group presentation
- Some advice regarding presentations

Assessment Format

Group Presentations: Format

- Final assessment in the course
- Contributes **5%** to your final grade

Group Presentations: Presentation component

- Presentation in groups of 4 or 5 on an assigned topic
- Max **10 minutes** of presentation
 - Every member must speak
- All presentations will take place on **Monday, August 17**
- Use the classes this week and on Monday, August 10 to prepare and practice

Presentation Advice

Presentation advice

- Structure
- Aesthetics and layout
- Presentation tips

Structure: Possible template

- **Background/Introduction** (2-3 slides)
 - Broad overview, Explain/define essential ideas/concepts
- **Important discussion points** (2-3 slides)
 - Highlight important points based on your research
- **Reflections** (1-2 slides)
 - What does your group feel about the topic? Why is the topic relevant for information science students?
- **Summary** (1 slide)
 - Recap of important points

You can organize your presentation differently as long as you include everything mentioned in the template

Aesthetics and layout

- Have a consistent style/font/colour scheme
- Avoid text-heavy slides
 - Ensure there is adequate empty space
 - If necessary, have text appear one point at a time
- Avoid complete sentences (unless you are quoting someone)
 - Highlight important points/terms using bold font/different colour

Presentation tips: Timing

- Budget for **60-90 seconds per slide**. More if the slide has complex ideas/graphs
- Speak slowly and clearly
 - Take your time for each point
- Avoid packing too much content
 - This will make you rush through the slide
 - Okay to end early, but you will be penalized if you exceed 10 minutes

Presentation tips: Content

- Do not assume that your classmates are familiar with the topic
- Slide content should be self-explanatory
 - Audience should be able to follow even if they briefly stop listening to you
- Have informative titles
 - Purpose/point of having that slide

Presentation tips: Practice

- Important to **rehearse**
 - You should be familiar with the slides and you will also have a sense for timing
- Do not read from a script during the presentation
- Penalty for insufficient practice and/or reading from a script

Any questions?